Made up of over 300 individuals, the Assembly met for 11 sessions that spanned 165 days. The product of their labours was the document that laid the foundations of the modern Indian state.

The Assembly was chosen via indirect election and nomination, and committees were appointed to research and present reports on specific issues, which were then thoroughly discussed. A Drafting Committee was nominated and tasked with preparing a draft constitution, which was then put up for further discussion. The members of the Assembly were a reasonably diverse group (although dominated by upper-caste Hindu men from the Congress, the Constituent Assembly included fifteen women and representatives from other religious groups), with a variety of ideologies, beliefs and perspectives. This made for lively debates on a wide range of issues, such as what the official language of India should be, whether there should be reservations for historically disadvantaged communities and what rights could be granted to all citizens.

India’s constitution-making process was among the first of its kind in the world. The many hours the Assembly spent resulted in a progressive, ambitious and egalitarian document. This section features a few of the remarkable people who helped create it.